

According to the 2024 Census, 62.1 percent of females aged 15–49 years are currently married, representing a decrease of 5 percentage points compared with the 2012 Census.

The percentage distribution of married women of childbearing age by age group has changed between 2012 and 2024. In 2012, the highest percentage of married women was observed in the 30–34 years age group, whereas by 2024, the highest percentage had shifted to the 40–44 years age group. Furthermore, during this period, a decrease in the percentage of married women was observed in all age groups between 15 and 34 years.

Age-Specific Fertility Rates (ASFR)

The Age-Specific Fertility Rate (ASFR) represents the number of live births per 1,000 women in a specific age group. ASFRs provide information on the ages at which women begin and end childbearing and, when compared over time, reveal changes in childbearing patterns.

Accordingly, in line with international standards and to ensure comparability of Sri Lanka's population data with other countries, Age-Specific Fertility Rates (ASFR) and the Total Fertility Rate (TFR) are provided for all females in the reproductive age group of 15–49 years.

In this census, fertility rates have been calculated considering the year 2024, using information collected in the census and applying demographic theories and methodologies.

Table 9.14 shows the age-specific fertility rates of females in the reproductive age group, based on information collected at the Censuses of Population and Housing in 2012 and 2024.

Table 9.14 : Age-Specific Fertility Rates (ASFR), 2012 and 2024

Age group	Fertility Rate (per 1,000 women)		
	1981	2012	2024
15-19	38	36	7
20-24	177	107	41
25-29	226	147	86
30-34	204	118	83
35-39	90	58	38
40-44	28	16	9
45-49	4	2	1

According to Table 9.14, the Age-Specific Fertility Rates (ASFR) for almost all age groups show a notable decline between 2012 and 2024. In both the Population and Housing censuses in 2012 and 2024. The highest fertility rate is reported in the 25–29 age group, with 86 live births per 1,000 females. The number of live births per 1,000 females in the 15–19 age group has also decreased sharply by 2024. The lowest ASFR is observed among females aged 45–49, with only 1 live birth per 1,000 females in that age group in 2024.